

ROADMAN CYCLING

FASTER AFTER 40

What World Tour Coaches Actually
Prescribe to Riders Your Age

COACHING

NUTRITION

STRENGTH

RECOVERY

COMMUNITY

NOT DONE YET

Anthony Walsh

Host, Roadman Cycling Podcast

100M+ downloads

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Five pillars. Five frameworks. One system. Everything grounded in the latest research and the conversations I have had with the best coaches in the sport.

A Note From Anthony

I turned 40 and immediately got slower. That is what was supposed to happen, anyway. The internet told me so. The forums told me so. My legs, frankly, were starting to agree.

I remember the exact ride. A Wednesday evening chain gang I had been doing for years. The move went on the second lap and I watched six wheels drift away from me like a door closing in slow motion. I had the fitness to be there. I had the hours. What I did not have was the right system for a body that had quietly changed the rules.

That was five years ago. Since then, I have spent thousands of hours talking to the people who actually solve this problem for a living. Dan Lorang, Head of Performance at Red Bull–Bora–Hansgrohe, the man behind Jan Frodeno, Lucy Charles-Barclay, and Mark Cavendish. Professor Stephen Seiler, the exercise physiologist whose polarised training research reshaped how the entire sport thinks about intensity. Dr David Dunne. John Wakefield. Joe Friel. Coaches and scientists who work with the best endurance athletes on the planet.

I asked all of them the same question: what actually changes after 40, and what do you prescribe differently when it does?

Their answers surprised me. Not because the science was impossibly complex, but because the fixes were remarkably specific. Specific enough to apply this week. Specific enough to work for someone with a job, a family, and eight hours a week to train.

This report is those answers, distilled across 100 million podcast downloads worth of conversations. It covers the five pillars that determine whether you get faster or slower from here: coaching, nutrition, strength and conditioning, recovery, and community. Each chapter is grounded in the latest research, referenced by name, and paired with a practical framework you can act on immediately.

I wrote it for a simple reason. Too many riders over 40 are training hard and going nowhere, and the gap between what they are doing and what actually works is smaller than they think.

You are not done yet. And this is where it starts.

Anthony Walsh

Host, Roadman Cycling Podcast

Who This Report Is For

You are over 40. You ride seriously. You have a job, probably a family, and somewhere between six and twelve hours a week to train. You have spent money on plans, apps, and equipment, and you are still not where you want to be.

Maybe your FTP has flatlined. Maybe you signed up for the Étape or the Marmotte and you want to perform, not just survive. Maybe you were fit once and you are clawing your way back. Or maybe you have been listening to the podcast for two years and your training still has not actually changed.

Whatever brought you here, you share one thing with every rider in this report: the belief that there is more in you. You are right. And the gap between where you are and where you could be is almost certainly smaller and more fixable than you think.

What you will walk away with: a research-grounded understanding of what changes in your body after 40, five practical frameworks you can apply this week, and the specific methods that World Tour coaches use with riders your age. No filler. No motivational fluff. Just the information that actually moves the needle.

CHAPTER ONE

COACHING

Structured training for a body that changed the rules

The 40+ Body: What Actually Changes

From around your fortieth birthday, your maximal aerobic capacity starts declining at roughly 5–10 per cent per decade. That is the headline number, and it is real. A 2022 meta-analysis in the *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health* tracked masters endurance athletes and confirmed this rate, but with a critical caveat: 54 per cent of the variance in VO_2max decline in male athletes was explained by changes in training volume, not by age itself.

Read that again. More than half the decline most riders blame on getting older is actually caused by training less hard, less consistently, or less intelligently. Age provides the headwind. Training decisions determine how much it slows you down.

Professor Stephen Seiler, the exercise physiologist whose research at the University of Agder in Norway fundamentally reshaped how endurance sport thinks about training intensity, puts it more bluntly. When I had him on the podcast, he said the single biggest mistake masters athletes make is drifting into the grey zone: riding too hard on easy days and too easy on hard days, accumulating fatigue without driving adaptation. His data from hundreds of elite endurance athletes across cycling, rowing, running, and cross-country skiing shows the same pattern: roughly 80 per cent of total training volume at genuinely easy intensity, and 20 per cent at genuinely hard intensity. Very little time in the middle.

The 80/20 model is not a suggestion. It is the distribution that emerged when Seiler measured what the best endurance athletes in the world actually do. And for riders over 40, it matters even more, because recovery from moderate-hard efforts takes longer than it did at 30, while the body's response to properly polarised stimuli remains remarkably intact.

"The grey zone is where masters athletes go to stagnate. They feel like they are training hard. They are. They are just training hard in a way that accumulates fatigue faster than it drives adaptation."

— Professor Stephen Seiler, University of Agder

How World Tour Periodisation Translates to Your Schedule

Dan Lorang's philosophy at Red Bull–Bora–Hansgrohe is built on a principle that applies directly to the time-constrained amateur: build the aerobic system first, protect it at all costs, and layer intensity on top only when the base is stable.

When I asked Lorang how he adapts World Tour periodisation for amateurs with six to ten hours a week, his answer was immediate. Protect the consistency of the structure, not the maximum intensity of any single session. A rider who completes four structured sessions a week for twelve weeks will outperform a rider who smashes five sessions one week and collapses the next.

For masters athletes, this principle is magnified. The fatigue cost of consecutive hard weeks rises sharply after 40. Where a 28-year-old professional might build for three weeks and recover for one, Lorang recommends masters riders use a 2:1 ratio: two weeks of progressive loading, followed by a recovery week. The recovery between hard sessions also stretches, from roughly 24 hours in a younger athlete to

48–72 hours for a rider over 40.

John Wakefield, another Bora–Hansgrohe coach, prescribes a specific session that has become a recurring theme on the podcast: low-cadence torque intervals. Four-minute efforts on a climb at 40–60 RPM, four repetitions, four minutes of recovery between each. The 2024 Hebisz and Hebisz study published in *PLOS ONE* finally validated what Wakefield and other World Tour coaches had been prescribing for years: the low-cadence group improved VO_2max by 8.7 per cent compared with 4.6 per cent for those using freely chosen cadence. Maximum aerobic power rose 8.1 per cent versus 3 per cent.

Why does it work? Low-cadence intervals force your type II (fast-twitch) muscle fibres to work at aerobic intensities. The brain learns to recruit more fibres per pedal stroke. The aerobic engine expands without adding training volume. For a time-starved rider over 40, that is an extraordinary return on investment.

“Protect the structure. A consistent system beats a heroic week followed by a crash. Every time.”

— Dan Lorang, Head of Performance, Red Bull–Bora–Hansgrohe

The Sweet-Spot Question

The polarised-versus-sweet-spot debate has broken more training confidence than any other argument in amateur cycling. A 2025 review in *Frontiers in Physiology* on training intensity distribution offered an important clarification: the distribution is a principle, not a recipe. Context matters. Training age, total volume, life stress, and periodisation phase all determine what the distribution should look like in any given block.

For time-constrained masters cyclists, sweet-spot work has a practical role. Three sets of twelve minutes at 88–94 per cent of FTP, once a week, produces threshold and lactate-clearance adaptations with relatively short sessions. But it sits *within* a polarised framework, not instead of one. The danger is when sweet-spot becomes the default for every ride, every week, which is precisely the grey-zone trap Seiler warns about.

Protecting high-intensity sessions is the single biggest lever for holding fitness into your fifties and sixties. Those who maintain training intensity lose roughly 5 per cent of VO_2max per decade. Those who let intensity drift lose closer to 10 per cent. The quality of your hard sessions matters more than the quantity of your easy ones.

YOUR THIS-WEEK COACHING FRAMEWORK

- **Audit your intensity split.** Check your last four weeks in TrainingPeaks or Strava. If more than 25% of your time is between 76–90% of threshold heart rate, you are in the grey zone. Pull easy rides easier. Make hard sessions genuinely hard.
- **Adopt a 2:1 build-recovery ratio.** Two weeks of progressive loading, one recovery week. Repeat. Do not push through a third hard week because you feel good. The adaptation happens in the recovery.
- **Add one torque session per week.** Find a 4–7% gradient. Four minutes at 40–60 RPM, RPE 7/10. Four reps, four minutes recovery. Start with three reps if you are new to this.
- **Protect your structure.** Four sessions completed consistently across twelve weeks beats six sessions in a chaotic pattern. Cancel the heroic week. Keep the system.
- **Consider one sweet-spot session per week** (3×12 min at 88–94% FTP) if you have fewer than eight hours to train. This sits alongside, not instead of, your polarised base.

The Missing Piece

A framework is a starting point. What the 113 members of Not Done Yet get is the same methodology applied to their specific context: their hours, their history, their race calendar. Structured training plans powered by Vekta, weekly live coaching calls, and a community of riders who understand that a Wednesday chain gang matters as much as any race. The coaching does not stop at a PDF.

CHAPTER TWO

NUTRITION

Fuelling for performance when the metabolism rewrites
its own rules

The Fuelling Myth That Makes You Slower

Calories in, calories out. Ride more, eat less. This is the advice the cycling internet has been serving up for two decades, and it is not just incomplete. It is actively making riders over 40 slower, heavier, and more miserable on the bike.

I lost 7 kilograms in twelve weeks. I went from 86 to 79 kg. My power did not drop. My energy went up. I stopped craving junk food at nine in the evening. And I did it while eating more food than I had eaten in my entire life. What I did not do was download MyFitnessPal and start tracking calories. What I did not do was skip meals or ride fasted at six in the morning.

What I did was work with Dr David Dunne and apply the same principles that World Tour nutritionists use with professional riders. The shift is fundamental: you eat to fuel performance. Weight loss becomes a byproduct of eating the right things at the right times, not a goal you chase through restriction.

What Changes After 40

After 40, several metabolic shifts conspire against the restricted-eating approach. Resting metabolic rate declines by approximately 1–2 per cent per decade, driven largely by the loss of metabolically active muscle tissue. Insulin sensitivity decreases, making the body more efficient at storing carbohydrate as fat when it arrives in large, irregular doses. Anabolic resistance increases, meaning your muscles need a stronger protein signal to trigger the same repair and growth response they managed effortlessly at 25.

The practical consequence: eating less does not produce the same results it once did. Restricting calories below your training demands triggers a cortisol response, promotes muscle catabolism, and drives the evening cravings that undo whatever deficit you created during the day. For a cyclist over 40, the caloric restriction approach is not just ineffective. It is physiologically counterproductive.

A 2024 study evaluating dietary intake at the World Masters Athletics Championships found that carbohydrate intake among masters athletes was consistently below recommended levels for endurance performance. Protein intake was similarly inadequate. These athletes were not undereating because they lacked discipline. They were undereating because the dominant advice in the sport still promotes restriction over fuelling.

Race Weight Versus Health Weight

Body composition is the hidden universal motivator in this audience. Almost every cyclist over 40 cares about it deeply but rarely talks about it openly. The conversation matters, but it needs reframing.

Race weight is a number on the scale. Health weight is a body composition that supports performance, recovery, and longevity. For a masters cyclist, the distinction is critical. Chasing a number on the scales often means losing muscle alongside fat, which is precisely the wrong trade when you are already fighting age-related sarcopenia. The rider who loses 4 kg of muscle to drop 6 kg on the scale has a worse watts-per-kilogram ratio than when they started.

What Dr Dunne prescribes instead is a body-composition approach. Adequate protein to protect and build lean tissue. Carbohydrate periodised around training demands. Fat as a stable, non-negotiable baseline.

The scale number follows. It just follows the right composition.

“Stop weighing yourself and start fuelling your sessions. When the training quality goes up, the body composition follows. Every single time.”

— Dr David Dunne, Sports Scientist, Roadman Cycling Podcast

In-Ride Nutrition: The 120g Revolution

In-ride fuelling has been completely rewritten in the past three years. Where riders once consumed 30–60 grams of carbohydrate per hour, the current evidence—and current World Tour practice—supports 90–120 grams per hour for rides lasting longer than 2.5 hours at race intensity.

A 2025 review in *Sports Medicine*, aggregating data from 61 studies, found that dual-transport carbohydrate (a 2:1 glucose-to-fructose ratio) at rates of 90–120 g/hr improved time-trial performance by 5–8 per cent compared with placebo, and by 2–4 per cent compared with intakes below 60 g/hr. The majority of the World Tour peloton now consumes 120 grams per hour during demanding stages.

For amateur riders over 40, the implication is stark. Most are drastically under-fuelling on the bike. Under-fuelling during a ride does not just reduce performance in that session. It triggers a stress response that impairs recovery, promotes muscle breakdown, and drives compensatory overeating in the hours after. The rider who “saves” calories on the bike often consumes more total calories across the day than the rider who fuelled properly.

The caveat: your gut needs training. The 120 g/hr figure is achievable only with progressive gut training across weeks. Start at 60 g/hr, increase by 10–15 grams per week, and prioritise a 2:1 glucose-to-fructose formula. Most riders can reach 90 g/hr within six to eight weeks.

The Protein Equation After 40

The International Society of Sports Nutrition recommends 1.4–2.0 g/kg/day for exercising individuals. For masters athletes, the practical target sits at the higher end: 1.6–2.0 g/kg/day, spread across four meals of 0.3–0.4 g/kg each.

A 2021 review in *Sports Medicine* found that while masters athletes do not metabolise protein fundamentally differently from younger athletes, the anabolic resistance that develops with age means the stimulus needs to be stronger and more consistent. Four evenly spaced, protein-rich meals is the most efficient pattern to support rates of muscle protein synthesis across the day.

The pre-sleep dose matters particularly for cyclists. A study referenced frequently on the podcast showed that consuming 30–40 grams of casein protein before bed enhanced overnight muscle protein synthesis in endurance athletes. For a rider doing a morning session, this means arriving at the bike with a body that has been rebuilding, not merely resting.

YOUR THIS-WEEK NUTRITION FRAMEWORK

- **Stop restricting, start timing.** Eat to fuel your sessions. Front-load carbohydrate around training. Reduce it on rest days. Total intake should support your training volume, not create a deficit.
- **Protein at every meal.** Target 0.3–0.4 g/kg per meal, four times daily. Add a 30–40g casein dose before bed on training days.
- **Train your gut.** Start in-ride fuelling at 60 g/hr with a 2:1 glucose-to-fructose mix. Increase by 10–15 g/hr each week. Target 80–90 g/hr for rides over 2.5 hours.
- **Prioritise food quality.** Whole foods for most meals. Supplements (whey, gels, drink mix) are tools for specific timing windows, not meal replacements.
- **Track body composition, not weight.** If your power is rising and your clothes fit better, the scale number is irrelevant. Body-fat percentage and lean mass are the metrics that matter.

Beyond the Framework

Nutrition is where most riders over 40 leave the biggest performance gains on the table. Inside Not Done Yet, members get direct access to evidence-based nutrition guidance tailored to their training phase, body-composition goals, and event calendar. The frameworks in this chapter are the foundation. The community is where they become personal.

CHAPTER THREE

STRENGTH & CONDITIONING

The non-negotiable discipline that most cyclists still skip

Why S&C; Becomes Non-Negotiable After 40

After 40, you lose approximately 8 per cent of your muscle mass per decade. Type II (fast-twitch) muscle fibres—the ones responsible for sprinting, surging, and cresting a climb without fading—shrink by 10–40 per cent. Bone mineral density decreases, particularly in cyclists, whose low-impact sport provides almost no osteogenic stimulus. Tendon elasticity reduces, increasing the risk of overuse injuries.

These are not abstract statistics. They are the reason your sprint has disappeared, your climbing power has dropped despite maintaining your FTP, and your knees ache in week three of a training block. And loaded resistance training is the only proven countermeasure for every single one of them.

A 2025 systematic review and meta-analysis in the *European Journal of Applied Physiology*, covering 17 studies and 262 trained cyclists, confirmed that strength training significantly improves cycling economy, anaerobic power, and time-trial performance with zero negative effect on VO_2max . The benefits were preserved in masters athletes. Two sessions per week of 30–40 minutes each is the protocol the research converges on.

A separate 2024 study published by researchers examining male master cyclists found that those who incorporated structured strength work reported fewer overuse injuries, better on-bike power production, and greater training consistency across the season.

“Cyclists who strength-train do not get slower. They get more durable. And durability is the single most underrated performance metric in masters cycling.”

— Roadman Cycling Podcast, S&C Series

The Bone Density Problem Cyclists Ignore

A 2025 UCI Sports Nutrition Project paper asked bluntly whether cycling creates a “perfect storm” for bone health. The answer was sobering. Cyclists tend to have lower bone mass than both other athletes and non-athlete controls. The low-impact, repetitive-load nature of cycling provides minimal stimulus for bone metabolism. Prolonged cycling creates metabolic perturbations that transiently increase bone resorption. And nutritional factors—particularly low energy availability—compound the problem.

For a rider over 40 who has been cycling as their primary exercise for a decade or more, the risk is real. A 2025 scoping review of exercise interventions for bone mineral density in low-impact sport athletes found that targeted resistance training was the most effective countermeasure, outperforming any nutritional intervention alone.

This is not about aesthetics. This is about whether you can crash at 45 and walk away, or crash at 45 and fracture a hip.

What to Do (and What Not to Do)

The cycling S&C; conversation is plagued by bad advice borrowed from powerlifting programmes. Heavy barbell squats, conventional deadlifts, and barbell bent-over rows carry an injury risk that is difficult to justify for a recreational cyclist over 40. The risk-to-reward ratio is wrong. A back injury from a deadlift does not just set your S&C; back. It takes you off the bike entirely.

What the research supports, and what the coaches behind Not Done Yet prescribe, is a programme built on patterns that transfer directly to cycling while minimising injury risk:

Single-leg work: Split squats, Bulgarian split squats, step-ups, single-leg deadlifts. Cycling is a single-leg sport. Training should reflect that. Single-leg exercises also expose and correct imbalances that bilateral movements mask.

Hip-hinge patterns: Kettlebell swings, kettlebell deadlifts, hip thrusts. These build the posterior chain—glutes and hamstrings—that drives power through the pedal stroke. Kettlebells load the pattern without the spinal compression risk of a barbell.

Core stability: Pallof presses, dead bugs, bird-dogs, side planks. A stable core transfers power from your legs to the pedals without energy leaking through a collapsing torso. Anti-rotation and anti-extension exercises matter more than crunches.

Upper-body pushing and pulling: Press-ups, dumbbell rows, resistance-band pull-aparts. Not for cycling power, but for postural health. Hours in the drops create muscular imbalances that manifest as neck pain, shoulder pain, and lower back strain.

Resistance-band work: Banded walks, clamshells, banded squats. Low-load, high-value exercises for hip stability, glute activation, and warm-up protocols. The unglamorous work that prevents the injuries that end seasons.

YOUR THIS-WEEK S&C; FRAMEWORK

- **Session A (30–40 minutes):** Split squats 3×8 each leg, kettlebell swings 3×12, hip thrusts 3×10, Pallof press 3×10 each side, press-ups 3×10–15.
- **Session B (30–40 minutes):** Single-leg deadlifts 3×8 each leg, step-ups 3×10 each leg, dead bugs 3×10 each side, dumbbell rows 3×10, banded clamshells 2×15 each side.
- **Frequency:** Two sessions per week, minimum 48 hours apart. Place them on easy cycling days or rest days. Never the day before a key interval session.
- **Progression:** Increase load by 5–10% when you can complete all sets with good form and one rep in reserve. Do not chase failure. Chase consistent, progressive overload.
- **Warm-up:** 5 minutes of banded walks, clamshells, and bodyweight squats before every session. Non-negotiable.

The S&C; Roadmap

Inside Not Done Yet, members follow a periodised S&C; roadmap that aligns with their cycling training phase. Base-building, strength-building, and in-season maintenance phases each have their own programming. The frameworks here are the principles. The roadmap is the system.

CHAPTER FOUR

RECOVERY

Sleep, stress, and the adaptation window your body needs

The Recovery Tax After 40

Recovery is where adaptation happens. The training stimulus is the request. Recovery is the response. And after 40, the response takes longer, demands more, and punishes shortcuts more severely than it did a decade ago.

The recovery conversation in cycling has historically been an afterthought. Ride hard, eat something, sleep, repeat. For a rider over 40, that approach is not just insufficient. It is the primary reason structured training blocks fail to produce results. You do not have a training problem. You have a recovery problem masquerading as a training problem.

Sleep Architecture Changes After 40

Sleep is the single most powerful recovery tool available, and it changes meaningfully after 40. Slow-wave sleep—the deep, restorative phase during which growth hormone peaks, muscle tissue repairs, and memories consolidate—declines by 2 per cent per decade from your late thirties. Total sleep time tends to decrease. Sleep efficiency (the percentage of time in bed actually spent asleep) drops. You wake more frequently. The architecture shifts, and with it, the quality of your recovery.

A 2025 systematic review and meta-analysis in *Frontiers in Physiology* confirmed that sleep deprivation significantly impairs athletic performance and increases perceived exertion. The effects are dose-dependent: each hour of lost sleep compounds the performance deficit. For masters athletes, whose recovery windows are already narrower, even modest chronic sleep debt creates a ceiling that no amount of training can break through.

A 2025 randomised crossover study showed that adding approximately 55 minutes of sleep improved both physical and cognitive performance. Not 55 minutes of extra training. Fifty-five minutes of sleep.

The practical implication is clear. For a masters cyclist, sleep is not passive downtime. It is the most productive part of your training programme. Protecting it—consistently, deliberately, and without apology—is a performance decision.

“You cannot out-train bad sleep. After 40, sleep quality is the rate-limiter on everything else: your adaptation to training, your body composition, your motivation, your injury resilience. Fix sleep first.”

— Roadman Cycling Podcast, Recovery Series

HRV: Listening to Your Nervous System

Heart rate variability—the fluctuation in time intervals between heartbeats—has moved from a research curiosity to a practical tool for training readiness. A 2024 narrative review in *Journal of Functional Morphology and Kinesiology* confirmed that HRV is a reliable surrogate for autonomic nervous system function, reflecting the balance between sympathetic (fight-or-flight) and parasympathetic (rest-and-repair) activity.

For a masters cyclist, the application is simple. A consistently suppressed morning HRV reading—lower than your seven-day rolling average by more than one standard deviation—signals that your body has not recovered from the previous day's training or life stress. Pushing a hard session on that day is not discipline. It is waste.

Modern wearables (Garmin, Whoop, Oura, Apple Watch) make HRV tracking accessible. The critical discipline is acting on the data. When your HRV says rest, rest. When it recovers, train hard. The riders who consistently outperform their age are not the ones who train the most. They are the ones who train at the right time.

The Stress Equation: Cortisol and Allostatic Load

Your body does not distinguish between training stress and life stress. A hard interval session, a deadline at work, an argument at home, and a poor night's sleep all draw from the same stress budget. The total cost to the body of constantly adapting to these stressors is what researchers call allostatic load.

Research on cortisol in endurance athletes shows a dose-response relationship: higher training volumes correlate with raised cortisol levels. But critically, athletes with high life-event stress show higher cortisol concentrations after exercise compared with those with low life-event stress. The compounding effect is real. A demanding week at work followed by a hard training block is not twice the stress. It is more.

In advanced overtraining, the stress system becomes fatigued. Cortisol output flattens or blunts, leaving athletes chronically drained, less motivated, and unable to respond to normal training loads. For a masters athlete juggling career, family, and training, this is not a theoretical risk. It is the most common reason structured programmes fail.

The fix is not less training. It is smarter stress management. Periodising training load against life stress. Inserting recovery weeks before they feel necessary. Protecting non-negotiable recovery practices: sleep, nutrition timing, and the deliberate absence of physical demand on rest days.

Active Recovery: What Works

Active recovery means low-intensity movement that promotes blood flow without creating additional training stress. For cyclists, this is a 30–45 minute spin at less than 55 per cent of FTP, or a 20-minute walk. Not a “easy” ride that drifts to tempo because you felt good. Recovery rides should feel almost embarrassingly easy.

The evidence supports active recovery over complete rest for clearing metabolic byproducts and maintaining joint mobility. But the key word is “active,” not “easy training.” If your heart rate exceeds zone 1 on a recovery ride, it is not a recovery ride.

YOUR THIS-WEEK RECOVERY FRAMEWORK

- **Protect 7–9 hours of sleep.** Set a non-negotiable bedtime. Dim screens 60 minutes before. Cool bedroom (16–18°C). If you wake in the night, do not check your phone. This is the single highest-return recovery intervention.
- **Monitor morning HRV.** Use any wearable. Check the seven-day trend, not single readings. If your HRV is suppressed, drop the planned hard session to zone 1 or rest. No exceptions.
- **Separate training stress from life stress.** High-stress work weeks get easier training weeks. Plan your hardest training blocks for your calmest life periods. This is not soft. This is smart.
- **Earn your rest days.** Recovery rides under 55% FTP. Not tempo. Not 'easy.' Genuinely easy. Or walk instead.
- **30g casein protein before bed** on training days. The overnight repair window matters more after 40 than at any other age.

Recovery With Accountability

The hardest part of recovery is not knowing what to do. It is actually doing it. Inside Not Done Yet, members hold each other accountable for the recovery practices that matter: sleep, nutrition timing, and rest-day discipline. Because the rider who recovers best trains best. And the rider who trains best gets faster.

CHAPTER FIVE

COMMUNITY

Le Métier — why training alone after 40 is the biggest performance limiter

The Accountability Effect

You can have the best training plan in the world. The most precise nutrition protocol. A strength programme designed by the finest S&C; coaches in the sport. And still go nowhere. Because adherence—actually doing the work, week after week, month after month—is the variable that determines whether any of it matters.

A 2024 study in *BMC Musculoskeletal Disorders* found that perceived social support significantly predicted exercise adherence over a six-month period. A 2025 study of adults over 50 in South Korea, published in the *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, found that social support was the strongest predictor of exercise adherence, outweighing financial barriers, perceived difficulty, and individual motivation.

The mechanism is not complicated. When you train alone, skipping a session costs you nothing visible. When you train inside a community, skipping a session creates a gap that someone notices. Not because they are policing you, but because they are doing the work alongside you and your absence is felt. That social facilitation effect—the research term for what happens when people perform alongside peers—is one of the most robust findings in exercise science.

For a cyclist over 40, the effect is magnified. Your life contains more competing demands than it did at 25. Your motivation fluctuates more. The gap between knowing what to do and doing it widens with every passing year. Community does not fix motivation. It replaces the need for it on the days motivation is absent.

“The French call it le métier—the craft. Being a cyclist is not just about fitness. It is about the culture, the customs, the community. The riders who last longest in this sport are the ones who belong to something.”

— Anthony Walsh, Roadman Cycling Podcast

What 113 Members Are Doing Right Now

Not Done Yet is not a Facebook group. It is not a forum. It is a structured community of 113 serious cyclists who are applying the same methodology you have just read about in this report.

Every week, members participate in live coaching calls with me. They follow structured training plans powered by Vekta, adapted to their individual schedules, their event calendars, and their recovery capacity. They have access to a periodised S&C; roadmap. They share race reports, training data, and the real conversations about what is and is not working.

The results speak in specifics. Daniel Stone went from Cat 3 to Cat 1 in a single season. Chris O'Connor went from 84 kg and 20 per cent body fat to 68 kg and 7 per cent body fat, doubling his average wattage. Yvonne Doran returned from illness, rebuilt her fitness through the programme, and competed in the Women's National Series. These are not outliers. They are the product of a system applied with consistency and community.

The standard tier is £15 per month. The premium tier, which includes direct coaching access, is £195 per month. The VIP tier, at £1,950 per year, provides the highest level of personalised support.

What Not Done Yet Provides

Structured training plans via Vekta, adapted to your available hours, your event calendar, and your training history. Not templates. Programmes built on the same methodology Dan Lorang and Stephen Seiler discuss on the podcast.

Weekly live coaching calls with Anthony Walsh. Bring your training data, your questions, your problems. Get specific answers from someone who has spent five years talking to the best coaches in the sport.

Periodised S&C; roadmap aligned with your cycling training phase. Base, build, and in-season maintenance programmes with video guidance.

Nutrition guidance grounded in the same evidence base covered in this report. Applied to your specific goals, your training demands, and your body-composition targets.

A community of 113 serious cyclists who are not beginners, not hobbyists, and not ghost-town lurkers. Active, engaged, and committed to getting faster after 40.

Accountability. The invisible force that turns a PDF into a performance improvement.

You Have the Knowledge. Now Build the System.

This report gave you the research, the frameworks, and the principles. But you already know that information alone does not change performance. If it did, every rider who listens to the podcast would be faster by now.

The difference between knowing and doing is a system. A structure. A community that holds the standard when your motivation does not.

Not Done Yet is where the work happens. If you are serious about getting faster after 40—not theoretically, not eventually, but this season—it is time to stop consuming and start doing.

ROADMAN CYCLING

NOT DONE YET

The community for serious cyclists over 40

WHAT MEMBERS GET

- Structured training plans via Vekta
- Weekly live coaching calls with Anthony
- Periodised S&C roadmap
- Evidence-based nutrition guidance
- 113 serious cyclists riding alongside you
- The accountability that makes it all work

STANDARD \$15/month | PREMIUM \$195/month | VIP \$1,950/year

APPLY NOW

skool.com/roadmancycling

"Cat 3 to Cat 1 in a single season."

— Daniel Stone, Not Done Yet Member

"84kg to 68kg. Body fat from 20% to 7%. Wattage doubled."

— Chris O'Connor, Not Done Yet Member

"Returned from illness. Competed in the Women's National Series."

You're not done yet. And this is where it starts.
— Yvonne Doran, Not Done Yet Member

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- Dan Lorang series — Full archive at roadmancycling.com/entity/dan-lorang
- Nutrition episodes with Dr David Dunne
- John Wakefield — Low-cadence torque training prescription
- S&C; Series — Strength training for cyclists over 40
- Recovery Series — Sleep, HRV, and stress management for masters athletes
- Lachlan Morton — The craft of being a cyclist

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